

Chapter Seven

Leadership





'How long can you stare at wife?': L&T chairman Subrahmanyam suggests 90-hour work week

"I regret I am not able to make you work on Sundays. If I can make you work on Sundays, I will be more happy, because I work on Sundays," Subrahmanyam is heard saying in an undated video circulating on social media

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PTI



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File picture of S.N. Subrahmanyam | Photo Credit: The Hindu



L&T HR head Sonica Muraleedharan said, 'Leaders like SNS (SN Subrahmanyam) inspire positive change and growth, and it's vital to recognize their efforts rather than misinterpret them.'

After L&T chairman SN Subrahmanyam found himself in a controversy after an undated video of him surfaced in which he was urging his employees to work even on Sundays, the company's HR head took to LinkedIn to share a long and detailed note on how his words were taken out of context.

Sonica Muraleedharan, who has worked with the multinational conglomerate for about five years, said she was present at the meeting where the comments were made.

"It's truly disheartening to see how the words of our MD & Chairman, [S.N. Subrahmanyam \(SNS\)](#) have been taken out of context, leading to misunderstandings and unnecessary criticism," she wrote. "Having been present during the internal address, I can confidently state that SNS never implied or mandated 90-hour work weeks. His remarks were casual in nature and have been misinterpreted, fuelling a controversy that doesn't reflect his true intentions."

L&T menstrual leave policy a 'progressive initiative', must be made 'mandatory': Netizens hail SN Subrahmanyam's move

Women comprise roughly 9 per cent of L&T's 60,000-strong workforce. The one-day menstrual leave will benefit over 5,000 women employees at the company.

Livemint

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S. N. Subrahmanyam, president of Larsen & Toubro

L&T Chairman SN Subrahmanyam, who came into the spotlight months ago for endorsing 90-hour work weeks, on Thursday announced that women employees in the [L&T parent group will now be entitled to one day of paid](#)

LEADERSHIP

Leadership relates to the ability to create influence, which help others to maximize their potential, toward the achievement of a goal

Leadership is the art of motivating a group of people to act toward achieving a common goal.



THEORIES OF LEADERSHIP

1) Trait theory

- ❖ It states that **leaders are born with certain personal qualities** that make them effective leaders.
- ❖ It focuses on **what leaders are like**, rather than what they do.

THEORIES OF LEADERSHIP

1) Trait theory

Prominent Leadership Traits

- **Intelligence** – Ability to think, analyze problems, and make good decisions.
- **Self-confidence** – Belief in one's own abilities and judgments.
- **Integrity** – Honesty and strong moral principles.
- **Determination** – Persistence and drive to achieve goals.
- **Sociability** – Ability to interact well and build relationships with others.
- **Emotional stability** – Ability to remain calm and composed under pressure.
- **Communication skills** – Ability to clearly express ideas and influence others.

THEORIES OF LEADERSHIP

2. Behavioural Theories of Leadership

- These theories of Leadership focus on **what it is that leaders *do*?**
- Behavioral theory focuses on **what leaders do**, not on their traits.
- It suggests leadership can be **learned by adopting effective behaviors.**

THEORIES OF LEADERSHIP

2. Behavioral Theories of Leadership

a) The Ohio State University Studies

Conducted by researchers at **Ohio State University**.

They identified **two main leader behaviors**:

❑ **Initiating Structure** – Focus on task, rules, planning, and goal achievement.

❑ **Consideration** – Focus on people, trust, support, and relationships.

THEORIES OF LEADERSHIP

2. Behavioral Theories of Leadership

b) The Leadership Grid / Managerial Grid

- ❖ One of the most significant contributors to behavioral theories of Leadership- **Robert R. Blake and Jane S. Mouton**
- ❖ They developed a method for classifying styles of leadership compatible with many of the ideas from the Ohio State and Michigan studies.
- ❖ They classified leadership styles based on two parameters - **Concern for results (concern for production)** and **Concern for people.**

THEORIES OF LEADERSHIP

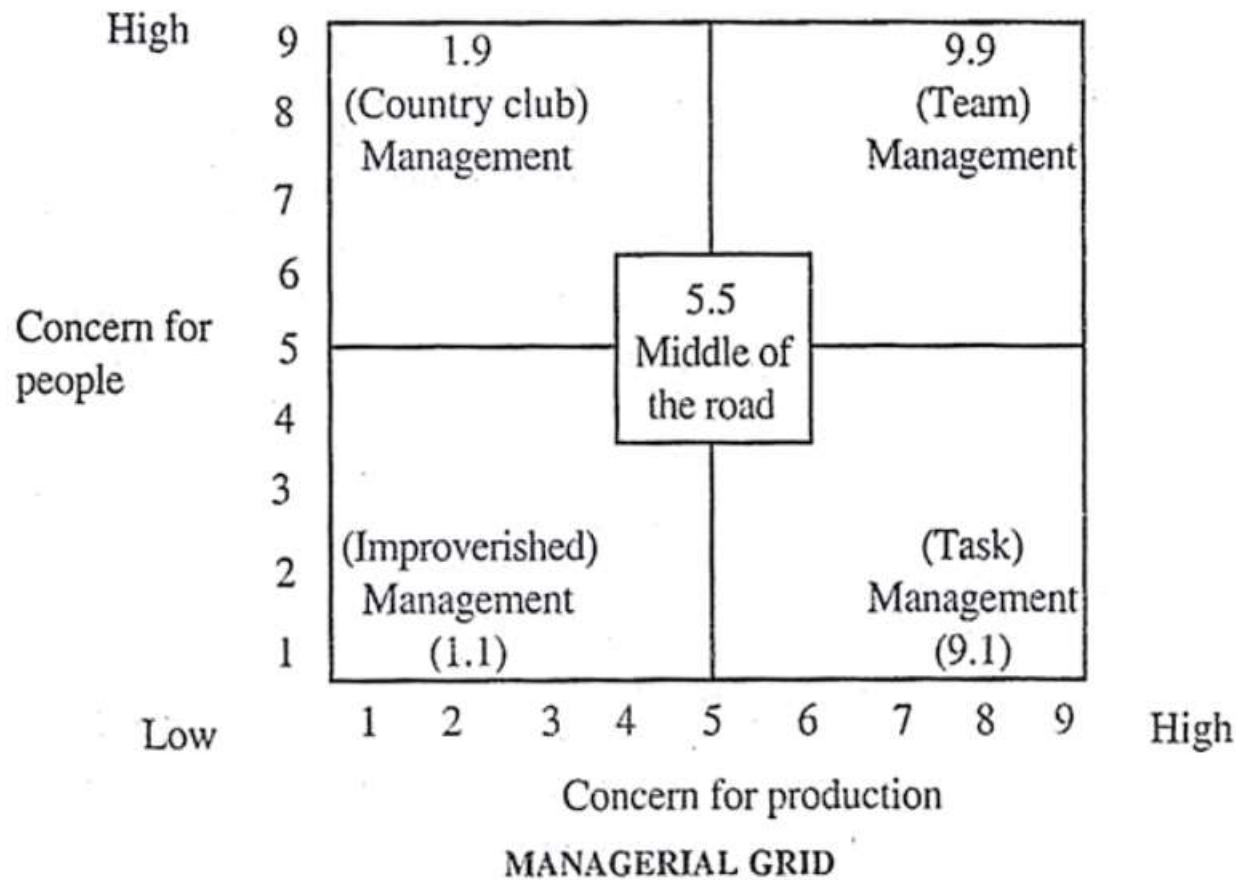
2. Behavioral Theories of Leadership

b) The Leadership Grid / Managerial Grid

- ❖ *Concern for results/production*: emphasizes output, cost effectiveness, and concern for profits.
- ❖ *Concern for people*: involves promoting relationships and paying attention to issues of importance to group members.
- ❖ Based on these two parameters they proposed – five different leadership styles in the form of a grid

THEORIES OF LEADERSHIP

- **1,1 (Impoverished)** – Low concern for people and work
- **9,1 (Task-oriented)** – High work, low people concern
- **1,9 (Country Club)** – High people, low work concern
- **5,5 (Middle-of-the-road)** – Moderate concern for both
- **9,9 (Team leadership)** – High concern for people and work (best style)



STYLES OF LEADERSHIP

Styles of leadership mean the different ways a leader behaves, makes decisions, and influences followers while guiding a group or organization.

1) Autocratic Leadership

Leader makes decisions alone and expects strict compliance.
Useful in crises but often reduces employee motivation.

Steve Jobs at **Apple** often made key decisions alone and expected strict adherence to his vision.

2) Participative (Democratic) Leadership

Leader involves employees in decision-making and values their input.
Improves commitment, creativity, and job satisfaction.

STYLES OF LEADERSHIP

3) Laissez-faire Leadership

Leader provides minimal direction and allows employees to work independently.

Effective with skilled, self-motivated teams but can cause confusion otherwise.

4) Charismatic Leadership

Leader inspires followers through personal charm, confidence, and vision.

Creates strong emotional commitment but may lead to dependence on the leader.

STYLES OF LEADERSHIP

5) Transactional Leadership

Leadership is based on rewards and punishments for performance.
Effective for routine tasks but limited in fostering long-term innovation.

6) Transformational Leadership

Leader motivates followers by creating a shared vision and encouraging change.

Enhances motivation, creativity, and organizational commitment.

E.g. Satya Nadella.

7) Servant Leadership

Leader prioritizes the needs and growth of followers over personal power.

Promotes trust, empowerment, and strong team relationships.

E.g. Herb Kelleher – Southwest Airlines

STYLES OF LEADERSHIP

8) Bureaucratic Leadership

Leader strictly follows rules, procedures, and formal authority.
Effective in highly regulated or risk-sensitive environments.

9) Expert Leadership

Leader influences others through specialized knowledge and skills.
Followers comply due to respect for the leader's expertise rather than authority.

E.g. Sundar Pichhai, Google.



thank you